Building and Equipping Your SDR Program

A complete guide to standing up your sales development function and choosing the right tools to run it

A DEMANDDRIVE GUIDE

demandDrive

Lay the Foundation

Define Your ICP and Targeting

Start with a clearly defined Ideal Customer Profile. Identify your target industries, company sizes, buying titles, and geographies. Layer in technographic and intent signals where possible. Your SDRs are only as effective as the lists they work, so invest here first. Build your TAM with a data provider, then segment by tier so your team knows where to focus.

Hire the Right Profile

Look for coachability, curiosity, and resilience over experience. SDRs with strong written communication and genuine interest in the product space ramp faster than career sellers who might be resistant to change. Build a structured interview process that tests for these traits. Include a mock cold call or writing sample as part of every final round.

ICP First

Define industries, company sizes, buying titles, and geographies before anything else.

Build Your TAM

Use a data provider to build your total addressable market, then segment by tier.

Structured Hiring

Test for coachability, curiosity, and resilience. Include a mock cold call or writing sample in every final round.

Build the Engine

1

Create a Repeatable Cadence

Design a multi-touch, multi-channel cadence that blends email, phone, and LinkedIn. Plan for **12 to 16 touches over 3 to 4 weeks**. Personalize the first and last touch at minimum. A/B test subject lines and messaging quarterly to keep conversion rates from flattening. Make sure every cadence has a clear exit criteria and a re-engagement path.

2

Establish KPIs and Reporting

Track activity metrics (calls, emails, LinkedIn touches) alongside outcome metrics (meetings booked, meetings held, pipeline generated, opportunities created). Review weekly. The goal is visibility into leading indicators so you can course correct before quota misses happen. Build a single dashboard that your SDRs, managers, and leadership all reference.

3

Invest in Onboarding and Enablement

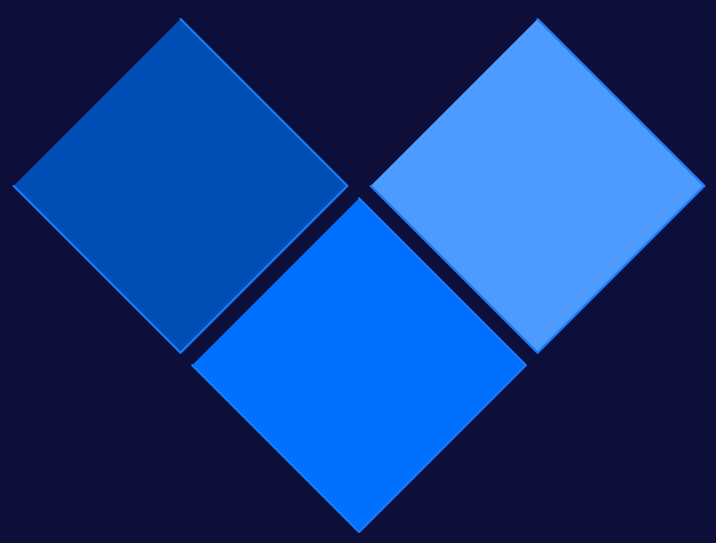
Build a **30/60/90 day onboarding plan** with clear milestones. Include product training, ICP education, objection handling, and live call coaching. Ongoing enablement should cover competitive intel, new messaging, and skill development. Programs that invest here see significantly faster ramp times and lower early attrition.

Cadence Design

Multi-touch, multi-channel outreach over weeks.

Enablement

30/60/90 onboarding, coaching, skill growth.



KPIs & Review

Track activity and outcome metrics weekly.

A well-built engine connects repeatable outreach, rigorous measurement, and continuous enablement into a single, compounding system.

The Core Tech Stack

CRM as the Foundation

Everything starts with your CRM. **HubSpot** is the go-to for teams that want sales, marketing, and reporting on one platform with a faster time to value and lower admin overhead. **Salesforce** is the right fit for organizations with complex lead routing, multiple business units, or heavy customization needs. Either way, the key is clean data hygiene from day one. Define your lead and opportunity stages, build required fields that enforce process, and make sure every touchpoint gets logged automatically. The best CRM is the one your team actually uses consistently.

Sales Engagement Platform

This is where your SDRs live day to day. **Outreach** and **Salesloft** are the established players for cadence execution, email sequencing, call logging, and task management. **Apollo** has gained traction with teams that want prospecting and engagement in one tool. For teams already on **HubSpot**, the native sequences and task automation can handle a lot of what a standalone platform does, especially for smaller teams that want to avoid adding another login and another integration to maintain. Pick the option that integrates cleanly with your CRM and dialer. The goal is a single workflow where reps can execute all outbound activity without leaving the platform.

Data and Enrichment

You need accurate contact and account data to fuel your cadences. The B2B data landscape includes providers like **ZoomInfo**, **Cognism**, **Lusha**, **Seamless.AI**, **Apollo**, **RocketReach**, and **LeadIQ**, each with different strengths across regions, industries, and data types. No single provider has complete coverage. The strongest programs use a waterfall approach, checking multiple sources in sequence to maximize direct dials and verified emails. Budget for ongoing data hygiene, not just initial list builds. Stale data kills deliverability and wastes rep time.

Scaling the Stack

Dialer

Phone is still one of the highest converting channels in outbound. A parallel dialer like **TitanX Dialer**, **Orum, or Nooks** lets SDRs multiply their connect rates by dialing multiple numbers simultaneously. For teams with lower call volume, a single-line dialer built into your engagement platform may be sufficient. Track connect rates and conversation rates separately.

Intent, Signals, and LinkedIn

Intent data from providers like **Bombora, G2, and 6sense** surfaces accounts actively researching topics related to your product. Layer these signals into your CRM so reps see them in context. **Sales Navigator** is table stakes for LinkedIn prospecting and should be a standard touch in every cadence alongside email and phone.

Conversation Intelligence

Tools like **Gong, Chorus, or Clari** capture and analyze sales conversations. For SDR programs specifically, conversation intelligence helps managers identify patterns in successful discovery calls and scale those behaviors across the team. These tools also accelerate onboarding by giving new reps a library of real calls to study.

Pro tip: Build your dialer reporting as two separate funnels. Dials to connects measures list quality and dialing strategy. Connects to meetings measures messaging and rep skill. If you lump them together you'll never know whether to fix the data or fix the pitch.

For intent, set up a weekly enrichment workflow that flags net-new accounts showing buying signals and auto-routes them to reps as priority accounts, not just a dashboard they check when they remember.

Clay as the Enrichment Engine

Clay has fundamentally changed how high-performing SDR teams approach data. Unlike traditional enrichment which relies on one or two data providers, Clay connects to over 170 sources, allowing for dynamic, multi-source enrichment workflows. This means you can gather firmographic data from one provider, add technographic signals from another, and layer on recent funding or hiring data, consolidating everything into a single, comprehensive record for your CRM and engagement platform.

For contact data, Clay allows you to waterfall across multiple providers. This eliminates coverage gaps, as Clay can automatically check alternative sources if a primary one lacks a direct dial or specific contact detail. This coverage stacking significantly boosts connect rates and data completeness across your prospecting lists.

Multi-Source Integration

Leverage 170+ data providers to build comprehensive profiles, combining firmographic, technographic, and financial data.

Waterfall Contact Data

Ensure maximum coverage by sequentially checking multiple contact data providers until a direct dial or email is found.

Actionable Insights & Personalization

Pull in LinkedIn activity, company news, competitor adoption, and hiring patterns to personalize outreach and prioritize leads.

Beyond contact details, Clay enables powerful use cases such as identifying prospects who recently adopted a competitor's product, filtering by hiring patterns to spot scaling teams, or enriching inbound leads in real-time for immediate, context-rich follow-ups. As a Clay partner, demandDrive builds and implements these advanced workflows for our clients. This ensures our SDRs work not just static lists, but enriched, signal-rich accounts, making every touchpoint highly relevant and responsive to market shifts.

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Tools that Drive Real Performance

The biggest gap in most SDR tech stacks is turning the right tools into measurable results. demandDrive closes that gap by partnering with best-in-class performance technology providers and embedding their solutions directly into our SDR programs. With innovators like **Second Nature, BirdDog, Syft, and Alysio**, we deliver purpose-built tools that help reps perform at a higher level.

AI Roleplay & Coaching

demandCoach, our AI roleplay gives reps on-demand practice with product, ICP, and objection scenarios. They get instant feedback, helping them ramp faster and communicate more consistently.

Real-time Account Signals

demandScout tracks high-value buying signals like leadership changes, hiring, and strategic initiatives. Those alerts flow directly into CRM, Slack, or email so reps can act immediately.

Website Visitor ID & Intent

demandSignals identifies anonymous visitors and scores them by intent and ICP fit. High-intent accounts are routed in real time for timely, relevant outreach.

Rep Performance Management

demandPilot gives managers real-time visibility into activity, pipeline, and skill development. It connects coaching, goals, and performance data in one place.

These tools are not add-ons clients are left to source on their own; they are built into how demandDrive runs programs. The result is a tighter, more responsive SDR motion with better signals, sharper reps, and stronger performance every day.

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Why Companies Partner with demandDrive

Building an SDR program from scratch takes time, infrastructure, and institutional knowledge that most companies don't have on day one. **demandDrive** provides fully managed SDR teams, proven playbooks, and the operational backbone to get programs up and running fast. We also operate across the full GTM engine, from sales and marketing to RevOps, so you're working with one partner instead of many.

Fully Managed SDR Teams

Trained reps, seasoned management, and structured onboarding so you skip the 6 month learning curve.

Proven Playbooks

Cadences, messaging, and processes built from hundreds of programs across software, cybersecurity, healthcare, financial services, and manufacturing.

Tech Stack Optimization

We help clients select, implement, and optimize their tools from CRM to Clay, so nothing falls through the cracks.

Your team sets the targets. We build the engine that hits them.

Book a consultation